

The TFE4141 Group Compatibility Questionnaire

Here are some questions we recommend that you discuss before you decide to form a group, or at least before you start working together.

Some of these questions might seem stupid now, but these are the problems that cause the majority of group arguments. By discussing this early in the semester you can avoid unnecessary annoyance or disagreements 😊

1. **Do you have compatible time schedules?** You might take different courses and/or have some additional responsibilities on the side (e.g. a job). For a group to work well, you need to find time in your schedules to meet on a regular basis (even if you plan to divide the work and do a lot individually, you will have to be able to meet and discuss things and collaborate).
2. **What do you want to achieve with this project?** Are you looking for a decent grade or a place in the "Hall of Fame"?
3. **How much time are you willing/able to use on the project?** Is this the course you are giving "your all" this semester, or are you planning to do the bare minimum to get by? Do you have many other time-consuming courses this semester? Are there weeks when you know you will be more busy than others? This is very important to discuss, so that you don't end up being angry with each other because person A is contributing "too little" and person B is expecting "too much".
4. **How do you plan to communicate with each other?** Communication is key if you want to function well as a group. Decide which platform (e-mail? Messenger chat? WhatsApp? Smoke signals? Other?) you want to use, and how quick you expect the responses to be.
5. **What do you do if you have been assigned a task and see that it is either too much or too difficult for you to do in time?** The best thing to do in a situation like this is to talk to the rest of the group and agree upon a solution (talking to a TA? Group discussion? Redistribution of workload?). Unfortunately, it is very human to solve this by panicking and hoping that the problem goes away if you stop thinking about it. This seldom works and can cause anger when the other group members find out that the work hasn't been done on time. As a group you should agree on how and when to alert the group to any difficulties, so that this problem is avoided. A good rule is to alert the other as early as possible, since that gives you as a group more time to find a solution.
6. **There is only one PYNQ-board per group – how are you planning to ensure that the keeper of the board does not end up doing most of the work.** Not all work requires the board to be present of course, but it is still important to discuss. Some groups solve this by meeting up and doing any work that requires the PYNQ-board together, for example during the lab sessions on Fridays.
7. **Who is responsible for handing in the assignments?** It is common in a group to assume that someone else has handed in the work, and then find out after the deadline that no one did (yes, this has happened to groups in this course before). Make clear agreements about this before each assignment.